

Course Instructor

Habib Ali

CONSTITUTION OF 1956





KEY HISTORICAL DEVELOPMENTS

- **1947:** Pakistan inherited the **Government of India Act 1935** as an interim constitution.
- **1949:** The **Objectives Resolution** was passed, setting the ideological framework for future constitutions.
- **1950:** First **Constituent Assembly** began work on the constitution.
- **1954:** The first Constituent Assembly was **dissolved** by Governor-General **Ghulam Muhammad**.
- **1955:** The **Second Constituent Assembly** was formed, and the **One Unit Scheme** merged West Pakistan's provinces into one administrative unit.
- **1956:** After years of debate, the **First Constitution** was finally enacted on **23 March 1956**, making Pakistan an **Islamic Republic**.



CONSTITUTION OF 1956

It was adopted by the 2nd Constituent Assembly on February 29, 1956, & enforced on March 23, 1956:

Articles: 234; Parts: 13; Schedules: 06

Federal System

East-West Wings
Equal
Representation in
the House

Foreign Policy

Maintenance of Close
Relationships with
the Muslim countries
of the world was
emphasized.

The President

Governor General was
replaced by the president.
Which made Iskandar
Mirza the first president of
Pakistan.
Head of State & Govt.

Rights of Minorities

The Rights of
Minorities were given
to ensure their
protection.

Fundamental Rights

Equality before law
Freedom of speech,
movement, religion,
Protection of property,
Privacy.

Independent Judiciary

No political interference.
SC: Highest Judicial
Authority

National Language

Urdu and Bangla
were made
National Languages
of the state.

Rigid Constitution

Any amendment in it
was needed 2/3rd of
majority of the
parliament.

Islamic Republic of
Pakistan





CAUSES OF FAILURE AND ABROGATION

- **Political Instability:**
 - Frequent changes in prime ministers (seven in less than four years).
- **Power Struggle:**
 - Rivalry between Governor-General/President and the Prime Minister.
- **East-West Disparity:**
 - East Pakistan demanded greater representation due to population size.
- **Weak Political Institutions:**
 - Lack of democratic culture and strong political parties.
- **Military Intervention:**
 - On **7 October 1958**, **President Iskander Mirza**, with **General Ayub Khan**, **abrogated the Constitution** and imposed **Martial Law**.

